TWO-PAGE EVIDENCE BRIEF

Trusted relationships. Meaningful creative development.

Silkfutures CIC • Cardiff • young people aged 11–25 • 24 October 2026

A young person may arrive for music. The work is also about having someone they trust: a mentor who helps them try, reflect, make choices and keep going. Creativity gives those changes a practical setting in which they can be seen.

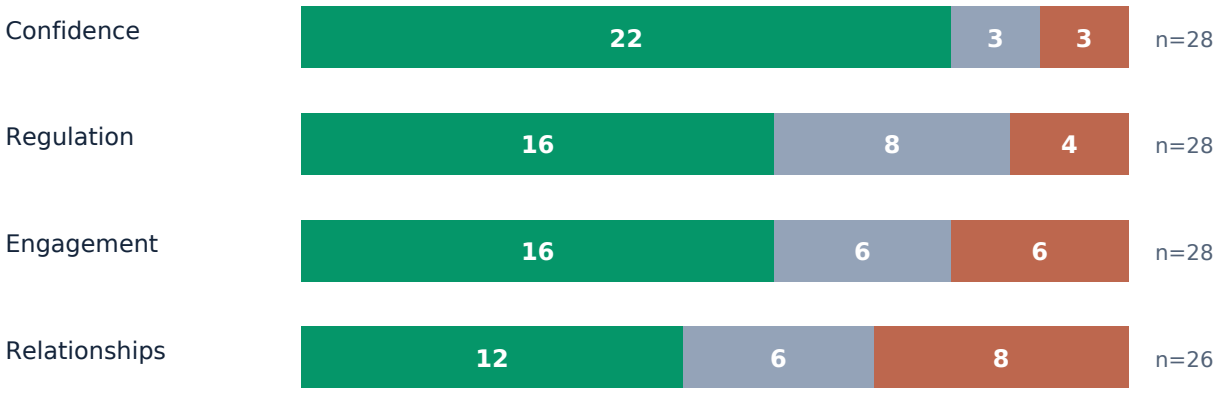
281
recorded engagements

89
recorded delivery dates

22 / 28
higher confidence ratings among paired identities

What the records show

Repeated mentor observations describe young people preparing work independently, responding to feedback, initiating creative tasks and completing recordings with less prompting. In one longitudinal journey, early supported songwriting developed into independently reviewing earlier work and choosing a new creative direction.



Green: higher • Grey: unchanged • Rust: lower. Counts of paired recorded identities; earliest versus latest rated date.

Source: all 284 rows of the supplied Pathways CSV; three registration-only rows excluded. Period: 14 January–13 October 2026. Engagements are participant-linked records, not separate sessions. Paired scores compare earliest and latest rated dates, averaging multiple same-day scores. Name labels are provisional identities.

THE MODEL AND THE INVESTMENT

Creativity is the vehicle. The relationship makes room for growth.

Structured without becoming impersonal

Discover and Cohort offer ways to connect and belong; Pathways 1:1 offers deeper mentoring; Alchemy focuses on artist development; Rise describes opportunities to contribute. The Reset, Reframe, Rebuild, Release and Rise framework helps mentors notice development across these offers. Progress is not assumed to be linear.

A careful interpretation is a stronger one

Confidence scores increased for 22 of 28 paired identities; three were unchanged and three lower. Relationship scores were more mixed: 12 higher, six unchanged and eight lower out of 26. Scores are subjective, context-dependent mentor observations. They do not establish clinical improvement or prove that Silkfutures caused the changes.

The export contains 73 distinct name labels, with unresolved aliases, so it does not verify total unique young people. Shared group records prevent a defensible total of delivery hours. There is no systematic post-exit evidence of employment, education or wider wellbeing outcomes.

What investment should support

Consistent mentor time, accessible creative settings, transport and participation support, supervision and credible evaluation. Funders should agree a defined cohort and delivery schedule, a fully costed budget and a proportionate reporting plan. Targets should distinguish participation, observable development and verified next steps.

A concrete costed proposal: the existing Alchemy application budget totals £11,245 for five artists, including £245 in-kind support and a £10,000 grant request. It is an application budget, not an award or evidence of achieved outcomes. Delivery-specification reconciliation is required before commitment.

Read alongside the Comprehensive Impact Report for methodology and anonymised journeys, and the Funding Investment Case for the Alchemy budget and delivery conditions. Evidence review dated 24 October 2026. Sources: full Pathways export; current application code; final Alchemy Create Project Budget. Cases require publication-consent review.

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